Unit 5 — Media Literacy

Track E · Klasse 9 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can spot 3 signs of misinformation in a short article.*
- *I can use seem to / appear to / claim to* for hedged claims.
- *I can write a 120-word media-literacy review.*

Lead-in I

Eli's uncle forwarded a viral post. The post claimed a new wonder-fruit could solve everything from sleep problems to maths grades. Eli read it twice. "Mr. Yilmaz," he said, "is *every fruit* like this?" Mr. Yilmaz smiled. "No," he said. "But every viral post is. Welcome to media literacy."

Vocabulary I

- source
- claim
- evidence
- fact-check
- misinformation
- disinformation
- bias
- headline
- clickbait
- study
- statistic
- anecdote

Vocabulary I

- primary source
- peer-reviewed
- fake news
- viral

Reading I

Vocabulary — media literacy
source, claim, evidence, fact-check, misinformation, disinformation, bias, headline, clickbait, study, statistic, anecdote, primary source, peer-reviewed, fake news, viral.

Grammar — hedged claims
seem to / appear to / claim to / be reported to + base verb.

- *The fruit **seems to** improve sleep.*
- *The article **claims to** be based on a study.*

Reading II

- *Critics **appear to** disagree.* Hedged language is what careful writing sounds like — neither lying nor over-claiming.

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Choose: *seems / claims / appears*: This study _____ to be peer-reviewed. The article _____ to support the claim, but the link is broken.
2. Match: clickbait → exaggerated headline; primary source → original. (T / F)

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 hedged-claim sentences about a viral post or article.

Your turn I

Mini-review, 120 words. Pick a viral post or article. Write a short review: *Source? Evidence? Bias? + what would change my mind*. Use 3 hedged claims.

Sample

The article I read seems to claim that a new fruit improves sleep, mood, and maths grades. The source is a small website I have never seen before. The article appears to cite a study, but the link is broken. The language is highly enthusiastic, which is a typical clickbait sign. I am not saying the fruit is bad — I am saying I cannot tell from this article. What would change my mind: a peer-reviewed study, a named researcher, and one critical voice in the article itself.

Reflect I

- I can spot 3 signs of misinformation.
- I can use *seem to / appear to / claim to*.
- I can write a 120-word media-literacy review.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Reality Check.
- Snopes — fact-checking site.
- FullFact (UK).